SHEIKH ATIYA ISLAM

Department of Economics, Pennsylvania State University
smi5203@psu.edu | +1 (814) 699-2021 | linkedin.com/in/atiyaislam | atiya-islam.github.io

Education

Pennsylvania State University Ph.D. in Economics — Expected 2027
Primary fields: Industrial Organization, Health Economics
Dissertation Committee: **Conor Ryan (Main Adviser)**, Joris Pinkse, Mark Roberts

University of Dhaka M.S.S. in Economics — 2019
GPA: 3.91/4.00

University of Dhaka B.S.S. in Economics — 2018
GPA: 3.99/4.00

Research Fields

Primary Fields: Industrial Organization, Health Economics

Secondary Fields: Applied Microeconomics, Environmental & Energy Economics

Job Market Paper

"Physicians' Location Choice and Access to Healthcare: Case of *Dobbs* 2022" *Job Market Paper*

This paper studies how local legal and regulatory environments affect physicians' geographic practice choices. I construct a novel state-year panel of major and minor abortion restrictions and link it to longitudinal physician practice-location microdata. Reduced-form evidence shows that a one-standard-deviation increase in legal permissiveness is associated with 0.089 more annual OB/GYN arrivals per 100,000 residents relative to general surgery, a magnitude benchmark equal to about 26 percent of the 2017–2021 mean annual OB/GYN arrival rate. I then estimate a county-level discrete-choice model with persistent heterogeneity in incumbent-location attachment; a one-standard-deviation increase in permissiveness is associated with about 6.3 percent higher relative odds of choosing a county as a destination, while incumbent physicians are more persistent in restrictive environments. Counterfactuals imply that, absent measured net tightening since 2015, about 427 OB/GYN physician-equivalents would have been geographically reallocated across counties by 2024, with a modest shift toward counties with lower baseline OB/GYN availability.

Research in Progress

"Role of Information on Physicians' Prescription Choice: Evidence from FDA Accelerated Approval"

This project studies physician product choice under evolving clinical information generated by the FDA Accelerated Approval program. I examine how prescribing responds as post-approval evidence changes and how updating varies with physician experience, prior prescribing histories, and market environments, with the goal of distinguishing persistent product preferences from information frictions.

"Energy Transition in the Context of the First Market-Based Cap-and-Trade Program in the U.S." *(with Emily Pakhtigian)*

This project studies plant-level adjustment to carbon pricing under the Regional Greenhouse Gas Initiative using EIA plant and generation data. We examine effects on plant operation, electricity generation, fuel use, and exit, including heterogeneity across regulated and deregulated electricity markets.

Teaching Experience

Pennsylvania State University — Instructor of Record
ECON 306: Introduction to Econometrics
ECON 104: Introductory Macroeconomic Analysis and Policy

Pennsylvania State University — Teaching Assistant
ECON 501: Econometrics; ECON 445: Health Economics; ECON 425: Economics of Public Expenditures; ECON 422: Applying Monetary Theory and Monetary History; ECON 304: Intermediate Macroeconomic Analysis;
ECON 104: Introductory Macroeconomic Analysis and Policy; ECON 102: Introductory Microeconomic Analysis and Policy

Research Experience

Research Assistant to Emily Pakhtigian, Penn State School of Public Policy
Research on electricity markets, environmental regulation, and firm responses to cap-and-trade policy.

Research Assistant to Conor Ryan, Penn State Department of Economics
Research on healthcare and pharmaceutical markets, physician decision-making, and applied microeconomics.

Research Consultant, East West University, Dhaka, Bangladesh
Tobacco research project: survey analysis, metadata analysis, and research-report preparation.

Academic Service & Mentoring

Graduate Assistant, Undergraduate Research and Fellowships Mentoring
Pennsylvania State University 2026–27
Mentor undergraduates on identifying research opportunities, faculty outreach, fellowship applications, and research-readiness programming.

Selected Presentations

- Pennsylvania State University, 2025
  "Energy Transition in the Context of the First Market-Based Cap-and-Trade Program in the U.S."
- Pennsylvania State University, 2024
  "Physicians' Location Choice and Access to Healthcare: Case of *Dobbs* 2022"
- Pennsylvania State University, 2023
  "Role of Information on Physicians' Prescription Choice: Evidence from FDA Accelerated Approval"
- 16th Asian Business Research Conference, Dhaka, 2019 — "Tourism and SDGs in Bangladesh"
- YSI Asia Convening, Hanoi, 2019
  "The Impact of Foreign Remittances on Income Inequality: Bangladesh Case"
- 15th South Asian Economics Students' Meet, Colombo, 2019
  "The Impact of Foreign Remittances on Income Inequality: Bangladesh Case"

Fellowships & Awards

- Humane Studies Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies, 2026
- Dean's List, 2018
- Prime Minister's Gold Medal, University of Dhaka, 2018
- Professor Dr. Nasrin Khondoker Memorial Gold Medal, University of Dhaka, 2018 — highest CGPA in the College of Social Sciences
- Shah A. M. S. Kibria Prize, 2018
- Shaheed Shafi Imam (Rumi) Memorial Scholarship, 2018
- Governor Scholarship, Department of Economics, University of Dhaka — outstanding academic performance

Computing: R, Julia, Stata

Languages: Bangla (native), English (fluent), French (B1) **Citizenship:** Bangladesh

References

Conor Ryan
Strumpf Early Career Professor of Economics
Pennsylvania State University
cxr5626@psu.edu

Joris Pinkse
Professor of Economics
Pennsylvania State University
joris@psu.edu

Mark Roberts
Professor Emeritus of Economics
Pennsylvania State University
mroberts@psu.edu